

PASSION DRAMA

...EDITED BY

Ugwuoke Albert C. (08135078459)

**Scene 1: JUDAS CONNIVES TO BETRAY
JESUS. <cast: Judas, Chief priests and
some soldiers.>**

Plot: The teachings of Jesus was already spreading throughout Judea, an effect that was beginning to undermine the treacherous teachings of some of the leaders at the time. Out of desperation and frustration, they sought means to kill him...Judas became the means.

<Dialogue:>

Judas (*while secretly waiting for the arrival of the chief priests having sent out a signal earlier:*

<In no distant time, the men arrived in the company of Zerah, and two chief priests).

ZERAH: This men said you have information that would deliver Jesus to us?

JUDAS: Yes, but...but...

CHIEF PRIEST 1: There's no but Judas. Tell him exactly what you told us. He's the ears and mouth piece of Cephas.

JUDAS: Very well then... My master and I share a great bond, that which can not be smeared... Neither would my actions be suspected too by others... We're having a supper later tonight...mmmmmmh (he clears his throat as he continued)... To divulge

more details, I need an assurance that my payment is guaranteed.

ZERAH: Name your price.

JUDAS: 30 pieces of Silver.

ZERH: Done! You shall have your payment soon after his capture. (He looks him in the eyes with fierce as he gleaned towards him)...

JUDAS: (he whispers in his ears the location of Jesus). I'll deliver him to you (he said with determination).

CHIEF PRIEST 2: You're doing the right thing Judas. Cephas would be proud.

<ZERA SHAKE HANDS WITH THE CHIEF PRIESTS AFTER SOME WARM EMBRACE AND DEPARTS. THE CHIEF PRIESTS FOLLOWED SUIT LEAVING JUDAS BEHIND. SOON AFTER SOME SOBER MOMENTS, HE LEFT.>

**Scene 2: JESUS GOES TO PRAY AT GETHSEMANE FOLLOWED BY HIS ARREST.
<cast: Jesus, Peter, James, John, Chief Priests, Judas, some Villagers and soldiers.>**

PLOT: Jesus took three of his disciples to GETHSEMANE to offer prayers ahead of his sufferings and crucifixion. As God, He had seen everything even before it began. Soon after his prayers, upon leaving with Peter, James and John, Judas, one of the 12apostles intercepted him alongside a multitude of soldiers and some villagers.

DIALOGUE:

JESUS: <while taking a walk> Peter, James and John, sit here while I go over there to pray. <taken by grief and

distress, he continued> My soul is crushed with grief to the point of death. Stay here and keep watch with me at least for an hour. <He went farther from them and and prayed>

<while he left to pray, the disciples fell to their knees to pray along but they fell as sleep in between.>

JESUS<in offering prayers> Father <he cried out>, everything is possible for you. Please take this cup of suffering from me. <and after some seconds he continued> Yet, I want your will to be done, not mine.

<While he returned to check on the apostles, he found them sleeping>

JESUS: Peter, Simon? Are you asleep? Couldn't you watch with me for even an hour. Keep watch and pray so that you'll not give in to temptation. For the spirit is willing yet the body is weak...

<He left yet again to say a similar prayer. Upon return, he found them yet again sleeping for they couldn't keep their eyes open. And they didn't know what to say.

JESUS: Go ahead and sleep. Have your rest. But no, the time has come for the son of man to be betrayed into the hands of sinners. Up! Let's be going. Look, my betrayer is here!

<while they left, Judas, one of the apostles whom had made arrangements for his arrest trooped in with soldiers and some servants, as well as some Chief priests. Having giving them a pre signal, he walked up to Jesus immediately upon arriving.>

JUDAS: Rabbi <he exclaimed followed by a kiss. At this point, the rest of the soldiers decoding the signal took hold of Jesus.>

JESUS: You betray your master with a kiss?

JOHN: What's happening?

JAMES: You betrayed him? How could you?

JUDAS: Listen, they just want to talk to the master. He must speak to the sahandrians.

PETER: They will kill him. Set him free, Judas!

JUDAS: They just want to talk...

PETER: They'd would kill him <at this point, he drew out his sword and cut of a servant's ear whom was there as a spectator.>

JESUS: Peter, sheath your sword. <he walks close the injured and healed him>. All who kill by the sword dies by the sword. <he continued>... Am I some dangerous revolutionary that you come with swords to arrest me? Why didn't you arrest me in the temple? I was there among you teaching every day. But these things are happening to fulfill what the scriptures said about me.

...<at this point, Zera gave the command having heard enough.>

ZERA: That's enough display. Bring him along...Arrest all of them. The elders awaits!

JESUS: You sought me... You have found me. Let them go!

ZERA: very well then, take him away.

Scene 3: JESUS IS TRIED BY CAPHAS AND SOME LAW MAKERS <cast: Jesus, Nicodemus, Caiphas, Man, Crowd, Zera, Aron, Pharisee, Crowd Against Jesus,>

<there's noise and incoherent voices in the court yard following Jesus arrest. While some saw it as long over due, some couldn't fathom the rationale behind his arrest >

ZERA <addressing the court yard> We are gathered this very night to bear witnesses to the public hearing of this man...This Jesus, whom had paraded himself alongside his multitude of deluded followers proclaiming himself as Christ. His actions are blasphemous and goes against the basic teachings of our doctrine. Hence, let's all offer our voices to the matter as we call on Caiphas, to begin the trials.

CAIPHAS <having entered calls for Jesus to be brought in.> Bring in the Blasphemer!

SOLDIER: Bring in Jesus!!!

<they brought in Jesus, tied and ill handled. Soon after, the trial began>

NICODEMUS: Villagers...Country men and women... Children!!! Behold Jesus of Nazeret, a preacher yet bounded like a common slave. This is unfair of a trial and unlikely sir!!!

<he moves to unbound the leash as he got intercepted by the soldiers which led to chaos in the court yard between those for and the few against.>

CAIPHAS: Jesus, it is not our genuine intention to treat like a criminal. But...We have come to hear reasons behind your teachings. Explain to this assembly, the nature of your preachings...What is this doctrine you and your disciples are spreading across Judea and beyond?

JESUS: I have taught in the temples...I have said nothing in secret. If I have said anything wrongly, ask those whom have had me preach. They are my witnesses.

PHARISEE: Oh yes! I have heard him preach on several occasions. His preaching threatens our doctrines and undermines the basic value of our existence. He's delusional and a blasphemer.

ARON: I beg to differ. This man here, Jesus, has done nothing wrong to thwart nor undermine our basic principles. I have heard him preach severally and I find nothing wrong in his teachings which denies the basic principles of our faith.

CAIPHAS: We fail to understand the meaning of most of your teachings. Your preaching contradicts the laws of the land. Same laws that were laid down centuries ago before you and I <he said looking at everyone>.

ABDON: Witnesses would agree that in one of your fool statements, you claimed to destroy the temple and rebuild it in three days.

NICODEMUS: No one destroys and rebuilds a temple in three days. His words carry meanings beyond our canal understanding.

PHARISEE: His words were as loud as a gong. Even the deaf heard him. He said he'll destroy the temple and rebuild it in two days.

Man 1: Three days, four day...Two days, even the witnesses can't even agree.

HAGGAI: How can we remember every detail that preceded his mouth. It's obvious he's a blasphemer...what other justification do we require to prosecute him according to our laws...Except we no longer have one...

PHARISEE: We need no other justification <looking and demonstrating to everyone>. He provoked a riot by proclaiming him self a king; a king of the Jews...

NICODEMUS: The riot was provoked by Barabas and his barbaric minions...<this he said angrily>

CROWD AGAINST JESUS: <in a heated debate> Jesus

CROWD FOR: barabas!

CROWD AGAINST: Jesus!

CROWD FOR: Barabas

MAN 2: Caiphas, this trial is becoming inconsequential.

CROWD AGAINST: Yes <they all shouted in unison>

MAN 2: We can't afford to have an uproar from this...Pilate would be displeased.

ARON: Ofcourse not! I do not see reasons for any uproar <looking at everyone in demonstration>. As Caiphas said, this is a trial to ascertain the innocence of Jesus. If he's found guilty by the standards of our law, we shall honor it...Until then, let him prove his innocence.

CAIPHAS: Jesus...most of your disciples call you messiah, the son of God. Tell me, are you the really the messiah, the son of God?

JESUS: You said it. But I say to you: you shall see the son of man sitting at the right hand of the father and coming in glory.

<Caiaphas tears his tunic saying...>

CAIPHAS: Blasphemy!!! Why do we need other witnesses?

CROWD AGAINST JESUS: Crucify him!!!<they chanted continuously; 3*>

<commotion ensues from the crowd between those for and against Jesus>

ZERA: That is enough! We have entertained as much as we can. We'll

take him to Pontius Pilate, in whose hands lies the final judgment. Take him!!!

<the crowd continued chanting as they took Jesus to Pontius Pilate>

Scene 4: JESUS IS BROUGHT BEFORE PILATE FOR QUESTIONING <cast: Jesus, Pilate, Zera, Haggi, Herbakuk,>

PILATE: I left the city for just a week and upon my return, the city is already in mess. What is this? What is the chaos about?

HAGGAI: Welcome Procurator. We found this man, this Jesus of Nazareth to be a blasphemer. He undermines the sovereignty and integrity of the emperor by proclaiming himself king, the anointed one. Furthermore, his teachings contravenes the very essence of our religion and goes on to corrupt the minds of people.

PILATE: I'm not interested nor concerned with his self proclaimed kingship. My function as governor is to keep the peace and establish Roman justice.

HABBAKUK: Yes Procurator. We know this but this man, this blasphemer threatens the established order. Leaving him roam the streets of Nazarene would destabilize and destroy Judea. Furthermore, if he wasn't a criminal, we wouldn't have brought him to you.

HAGGI: He calls himself Christ, which translates as the anointed one.

PILATE: Christ? The announced one? He must be delusional. Well, what else has he said? Has he spoken against Rome yet?

HAGGI: Well, Procurator, not directly.

PROCURATOR: Not directly...How else could you trial such a man. Deal with him in your own way...He's your problem.

HANZEL: My lord, for we the Nazarenes, this man, Jesus is a blasphemer and an enemy of the state. Perhaps, if we were a self governing nation, we would trie him according to our laws.

MAN 1: He made a triumphant entry into Jerusalem, proclaiming himself King of the Jews!!!

PILATE: King of the Jews? A king beyond my self? Does he have a kingdom? Does he wish to rebel against me?

QUINTILUS: My lord, that would be treason. His claims incites the people against you. Such treasonous acts must be punished!

PILATE: True! True!! I'll speak to him at once...Your Jesus!

All: Not ours!!!

PILATE: Whose? Whose?? Bring him in.

ZERA: Bring in Jesus.

<Jesus is brought in for questioning and examination. After gross examination, Pilate finds him innocent and moved towards whipping him but the people demanded more from the procurator.>

PILATE: <after examining Jesus> Is this the man you think highly dangerous? Is he whom you think would rebel against my government? Hmmm! So, Jesus...These people here accuse you of blasphemy.

They equally say you are the king of the Jews...You must be a king then..."

JESUS: Are you saying this of your own or did others tell you about me?

PILATE: Pilate answered, "I am not a Jew, am I? Your own nation and the chief priests handed You over to me; what have You done?"

JESUS: My kingdom is not of this world. If My kingdom were of this world, My servants would be fighting so that I would not be handed over to the Jews; but as it is, My kingdom is not of this realm.

PILATE: So, you're a king?

JESUS: You say directly that I am a king. For this purpose I have been born...And for this I have come into this world to testify to the truth. Everyone who is of the truth listens to my voice.

PILATE: What is the truth? Hmmmm! This man is not a criminal...He's a dreamer. Have him whipped as a token of Roman justice. That should wake him up!

<They took Jesus to the Praetorium to be scourged.>

Extracts from the scene:

SOLDIER 1: Take off his robes...Since he is the king of Jews, I'm sure his disciples would save him now.

ALL SOLDIERS: Hahahahahahaha

SOLDIER 2: He need no saving. He's the messiah; a savior...He could save himself...<he gleans towards Jesus> Right?

ALL SOLDIERS: hahahaha <they all laughed as they made caricature of him while they whipped him.>

<They brought him back after whipping him...>

PILATE: What have you to say now? You must have something to say...Please, say something. Do you want to die? Don't you realize I have the power to release you or crucify you?

JESUS: You'll have no power over me if it had not been given to you from above.

PILATE: I find nothing against this man. He has been whipped as a penalty for his blasphemy. That should do.

HAGGI: If this man were not a criminal, we would not have handed him over to you.

JEWS PRESENT: He must be crucified!!!

PILATE: Take him yourselves and judge him according to your laws.

HABBAKUK: We are not permitted to put anyone to death.

PILATE: Your ancient tradition of releasing a prisoner sentenced to death by the procurator as an act of mercy in honor of the Passover? ...We have two prisoners; Jesus or Barabas?

THE JEWS PRESENT: Barabas...Free Barabas!!!<they answered in unison>

PILATE: We'll allow the people to decide. I've made my decision. The people will decide.

ZERA: Bring in Barabas...

FIRST STATION: JESUS IS CONDEMNED TO DEATH.

<As they brought in Barabas, a group of country men, women and children followed suit to observe the proceedings> They shouted in their loudest of voices as they trooped in chanting

VILLAGERS: Free Barabas! Free Barabas!!
Free Barabas!!!

PILATE: As a just and generous governor, I have decided to honor your custom of releasing one prisoner sentenced to death in honor of the Passover. Behold, Jesus of Nazareth accused of treason by proclaiming himself the king of the Jews and Barabas, a notorious criminal charged with murder and insurrection against Rome...

CROWD 1: Jesus of Nazareth must die.
Blasphemer!!!

CROWD 2: Any body shouting for that false prophet is responsible of treason.

CROWD 3: Can you work a miracle now Jesus! Save yourself!

CROWD 1: Look at him...False prophet!
Tueeeeh <she spits on him in disgust>

MAN 3: If you call yourself a messiah, you must save yourself or command your angels to save you.

PILATE: Which of the two prisoners should be released to you? Jesus of Nazareth or Barabas, the babarian?

CROWD AGAINST JESUS: Free Barabas; kill the Jesus

CROWD FOR JESUS: Free Jesus, he's a true prophet.

CROWD AGAINST: kill Jesus!!!

CROWD FOR: BARABAS

CROWD AGAINST: JESUS!!

CROWD FOR: Barabas!!!

CROWD AGAINST: Jesus!! Jesus!!! Kill the Nazarene, he's an enemy of Cesar.

PILATE: I wonder who the enemy is...

CROWD AGAINST: Jesus of Nazareth!

MAN 1: False prophet...He betrayed us!

CROWD AGAINST: Kill the Nazarene!

<Pilate having seen releasing Jesus would make him an enemy of the people condemns Jesus and frees Barabas> ***This he did after washing his hands...***

PILATE: Let it be known by all bearing witness this day that I'm innocent of this man's blood, this Jesus of Nazareth.

CROWS 2: Let his blood be upon us and that of our children's children!!!

CROWD AGAINST: Yes!!! <they shouted in unison>

PILATE: Then let it be written... That Jesus of Nazareth, is guilty of treason and blasphemy by proclaiming himself

King of the Jews! And I hereby sentence him to be crucified!

<at this point, it became a thing of joy for those against Jesus and a day of sadness for the Crowd standing for Jesus!>

SECOND STATION <*Jesus carries his cross*>

THIRD STATION: <*Jesus falls the first time*>

FOURTH STATION: <*Jesus meets his mother*>

5th STATION: <*Simon bears the cross for Jesus*>

Sixth STATION: <*Veronica wipes the face of Jesus*>

SEVENTH STATION: <*Jesus falls the second time*>

EIGHT STATION: <*The women of Jerusalem weep for Jesus*>

NINTH STATION: <*Jesus falls the 3rd time*>

TENTH STATION: <*Jesus is stripped of his garments*>

ELEVENTH STATION: <*Jesus is nailed to the cross*> Soldiers tore his garment and cast a lot with it.

TWELFTH STATION: <*Jesus dies on the cross*>

JESUS: Son, behold thy mother...Woman, behold your son.....

THIEF 1: Jesus, you claim to be the savior, why not save yourself and save us as well...

THIEF 2: Keep shut. Are you not afraid of God. This man has done nothing deserving of such punishment unlike we... Jesus, please, remember me when you get to paradise.

JESUS: I promise you, you'll be with me in paradise.

<breathing heavily having worn out...He tasted>

JESUS: I taste

<the soldiers offered him a jar of soured wine. He drank it and spat it out.>

JESUS: Father...Why has thou forsaken me? <he teared up>...Eloi Eloi lamasabatani...

CROWD 1: Listen, he's finally calling on one of the prophets...

CROWD 2: It must be Elijah

CROWD: Or Moses perhaps...

CROWD AGAINST: hahahaha! <They all laughed in unison>

JESUS: <at the 12th hour, with a heavy breath, he passed on> Father, into your hands I commend my spirit...It is accomplished! <he dies>

THIRTEENTH STATION: <Jesus is taken down from the cross>

FOURTEENTH STATION: <Jesus is placed in the Sepulchre.>